

SANKAR INNAMURI

Chicago, IL 60623 | (813)-304-3903 | chandrahas.sankar@outlook.com | WWW: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/sankar-i/>

Summary

Cybersecurity Analyst with 5+ years of experience leading advanced investigations across macOS, Linux, and cloud environments in high-velocity, security-first organizations. Proficient in EDR and SIEM platforms including CrowdStrike, SentinelOne (Deep Visibility & FQL), Splunk, and Elastic, with strong expertise in SaaS/identity telemetry from Okta, Google Workspace, GitHub, Slack, and Atlassian. Skilled in building and tuning low-noise detections for OAuth abuse, MFA abnormalities, and privilege escalation mapped to MITRE ATT&CK. Experienced in proactive threat hunting, live response, endpoint forensics, insider-risk investigations, and correlating endpoint, network, and identity data to surface high-impact threats. Adept in Python/Bash automation, osquery, and YARA to accelerate analysis, improve precision, and enhance SOC response workflows.

Skills

- **SIEM and security monitoring tools:** Splunk ES, IBM QRadar, Azure Sentinel, LogRhythm, and AlienVault OTX
- **Network and infrastructure security:** IDS/IPS, NGFW (Check Point, Cisco), WAF, TCP/IP, DNS
- **Cloud security and platforms:** AWS (GuardDuty, IAM, VPC flow logs), Azure, hybrid Active Directory
- **EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon, SentinelOne, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Tanium, HIPS, HDLP
- **Automation and scripting:** Python, PowerShell, and SQL
- **Vulnerability management:** Nessus, Qualys, Rapid7
- **Compliance and governance:** HIPAA, PCI DSS, ISO 27001, SOC 2, NIST 800-53, NIST CSF
- **SaaS & Identity Security:** IAM, GitHub, MFA, OAuth Security
- **Threat intelligence and detection frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, OWASP ZAP, Splunk UEBA, DAST, IAST, and threat hunting

Experience

Security Consultant Amazon

01/2024 to Current
New York, New York

Environment: Splunk ES, QRadar, Azure Sentinel, LogRhythm, CrowdStrike Falcon, SentinelOne, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, AWS, Azure, Check Point NGFW, Nessus, Qualys, Kubernetes, PowerShell, Python

- Led **end-to-end incident investigations** in a 24/7 global SOC, triaging **20,000+ alerts per month** and driving containment, eradication, and recovery across endpoint, network, and cloud environments.
- Performed **digital forensics & evidence acquisition** from EDR tools (CrowdStrike, SentinelOne, Defender), including artifact collection, malware behavior analysis, host timelines, and chain-of-custody documentation.
- Conducted advanced investigations using **packet captures, network logs, and cloud telemetry** (CloudTrail, GuardDuty, Azure Activity Logs) to identify attacker TTPs and map activity to the cyber kill chain.
- Developed and tuned **high-fidelity detection rules** across Splunk and Sentinel using MITRE ATT&CK, improving detection accuracy and reducing false positives by **80%**.
- Investigated **web and application-layer attacks** (SQLi, SSRF, XSS, brute force, credential abuse) and implemented NGFW/WAF rule updates to block repeat attempts.
- Led **root cause analysis (RCA) & post-incident reviews**, reconstructing attack timelines, identifying detection gaps, and driving long-term SOC improvements.
- Leveraged **osquery, YARA, and SentinelOne FQL** queries during endpoint investigations to extract artifacts, validate threat indicators, and strengthen macOS/Linux detection coverage.
- Conducted **cloud-focused incident response** for AWS and Azure environments, performing IAM forensics, access pattern analysis, API misuse detection, and misconfiguration remediation.
- Executed **vulnerability investigations** using Nessus, Qualys, and threat intel correlation; validated 200+ high-risk CVEs and reduced remediation cycles by **40%**.
- Automated IOC enrichment, cloud log correlation, and case evidence preparation using **Python, PowerShell, and Terraform**, decreasing manual IR workload by **60%**.
- Authored and enhanced **incident response playbooks**, detection logic, and cloud IR runbooks aligned with NIST and industry best practices.

Cybersecurity Analyst Wells Fargo

01/2019 to 07/2021

- Operated as an L2 investigator in a 24/7 SOC, triaging **300+ alerts/day** across SIEM, EDR, and identity sources; validated threats, escalated high-risk cases, and executed containment aligned with kill-chain progression.
- Investigated SaaS and identity-driven attacks such as **OAuth misuse, suspicious MFA attempts, abnormal Okta logins, and privilege changes**, correlating events across Okta, Proofpoint, Defender, and Google Workspace.
- Led investigations for phishing, BEC, and credential compromise incidents by performing **email header analysis, URL/attachment forensics, and IOC extraction**.
- Performed endpoint forensics across **macOS, Linux, and Windows** using Defender and CrowdStrike telemetry—collecting artifacts, reconstructing activity timelines, and documenting findings.
- Conducted advanced cloud and network investigations using **VPC Flow Logs, CloudTrail, Azure Activity Logs**, firewall data, and VPN logs to identify lateral movement, unauthorized access, and API misuse.
- Executed containment and eradication actions during malware, identity, and SaaS-based incidents—quarantining hosts, revoking sessions, disabling OAuth grants, and coordinating with engineering teams to restore safe operations.
- Investigated vulnerabilities using Nessus, Qualys, and Nmap; correlated findings with threat intel, prioritized exploitable issues, and partnered with engineering teams—reducing patch backlog by **45%**.
- Tuned WAF/NGFW rules to block exploit attempts, brute-force activity, unauthorized API calls, and malicious traffic patterns, reducing exposure across remote workforce environments.
- Strengthened AWS and Azure detections by improving IAM visibility, enabling GuardDuty/Security Center signals, and monitoring identity + API anomalies—reducing cloud misconfigurations by **30%**.
- Automated SaaS/identity log parsing, IOC enrichment, and case evidence workflows using **Python, Bash, and PowerShell**, cutting manual investigation time by **50%**.
- Authored and updated playbooks for phishing, identity-based attacks, OAuth abuse, and cloud IR workflows, ensuring reliable and repeatable SOC processes.

SOC Analyst Mastercard

01/2018 to 01/2019

- Monitored Splunk and QRadar, performing **initial triage of 150+ alerts/day** and escalating validated threats aligned with cyber kill chain stages.
- Investigated **phishing and email-based attacks** by analyzing headers, URLs, attachments, and user activity; blocked malicious domains across proxy/firewall layers to prevent compromise.
- Conducted **endpoint forensic analysis** using Defender and Carbon Black by reviewing processes, registry modifications, persistence artifacts, and indicators of compromise.
- Documented incident actions, collected evidence, and maintained accurate **chain-of-custody records** in ServiceNow to support compliance, RCA, and repeatable workflows.
- Assisted with **vulnerability investigations** using Nessus and Qualys, validating remediation and ensuring high-risk findings were closed within SLA timeframes.
- Participated in **IR drills and tabletop exercises**, practicing escalation workflows, containment decision-making, and execution of IR playbooks.
- Supported PCI-DSS and ISO 27001 audits by preparing case evidence, security logs, and investigation summaries for review by internal and external stakeholders.

Education and Training

Master of Science: Cyber Security University of South Florida

05/2023
Tampa, FL

Certifications

- Certified in Ethical Hacking (CEH) | Security+ | Network+ | GCIA

Accomplishments

- Led investigation and containment of a cloud-based credential compromise, reducing dwell time by **70%** and preventing lateral movement.
- Built cloud-focused IR playbooks for AWS/Azure that improved detection accuracy by **40%** and cut investigation time by **50%**.